

Installations

The term 'installation' describes a mixed-media construction or assemblage usually created for a specific place and for a temporary period – they have become an increasingly popular form of art since artists used more diverse media in the late 20th century, allowing the creation of unique environments that can occupy an entire room or gallery, transforming visitors' perceptions of the space. Constructed in galleries, museums or public environments, they usually consist of numerous elements, and are a logical progression from styles such as Colour Field painting, which deliberately relinquished frames in order to make the work seem part of the wider world.

American performance artist Allan Kaprow created some of the first installations from c.1957. His concept of 'environments', became a significant element in modern art, treated uniquely by different artists. James Turrell (b.1943), for instance, creates installations focusing on light and space, while Anish Kapoor (b.1954), explores distortions of space in installations and permanent sculpture.



Anish Kapoor, *Ascension*, 2003